

Chicago Tribune



★

\$4.00 | TUESDAY, AUGUST 4, 2026 | CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

ELECTION 2027

Johnson brushes off newest race entry

Mayor sidesteps bid by Giannoulias, says days of school closures over

By Alice Yin
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Mayor Brandon Johnson on Monday sought to sidestep the elephant in the room — the 2027 mayoral election — but also delivered a quasi-stump speech while taking fresh shots at the newest entry in the race.

Speaking at a Malcolm X College news conference with the Chicago Teachers Union, the mayor refrained from addressing Illinois Secretary of State Alexi Giannoulias by name following his Sunday campaign announcement for Johnson's seat. But he nonetheless launched thinly veiled attacks on his latest possible rival and his donors after announcing the expansion of 15 sustainable community schools.

"My job is to continue to govern and lead in this moment, and as far as the politics of Chicago, there's a reason why we call it the Windy City, right?" Johnson told reporters when asked about Giannoulias' candidacy. "You'll have different waves of people blowing in and out. But the thing that's most constant, what's most still, and what's what remains today, is the Johnson administration."

It was the latest instance of the mayor awkwardly dancing around committing to a reelection bid while the field to succeed him gets crowded. Johnson has raised little money for a potential run, and has stuck to a script of focusing on "building the safest, most affordable big city in America" when asked about his looming decision.

But with Giannoulias in the race, Johnson and his progressive coalition have their most heavily funded rival yet, should the incumbent mayor choose to run. And Johnson's anti-establishment roots were on full display Monday as he sought to tie the new expected frontrunner to the Rahm Emanuel administration.

"Right now, you have people who are declaring their candidacy for offices while already giving the word that they're going to close schools," Johnson said. "The same interests that shut down schools, the same interests that closed mental health clinics, the same interests that fired working people across this city — those same interests want to take us back to a time of trauma and torment and pain."

He went on to attack those "interests" further, accusing them of supporting President Donald Trump's tax cuts or having no plan to respond to his federal immigration campaign in Chicago last fall, before knocking unspecified politicians who are beholden to "the interest of corporations."

See **JOHNSON** on Page A4



New Cubs relief pitcher Ryan Zeferjahn. **BAILEY HILLESHEIM/AP**

Cubs, Sox deal at trade deadline

Pitchers Kevin Gausman, Clay Holmes and Ryan Zeferjahn, above, highlight Cubs trade deadline acquisitions, while Sox add catcher Joey Bart, outfielder Brenton Doyle and others.

Chicago Sports



Workers pack up Lollapalooza stages and tents in the muddy Hutchinson Field area at the south end of Chicago's Grant Park on Monday.

BRIAN CASSELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Lollapalooza leaves city with muddy aftermath

Festival wrapped with some arrests, hospital trips while Chicago faces cleanup

By Evgenia Anastasakos, A.D. Quig and Alice Yin
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

Visiting Chicago for work, Julie Radakovich and Sarah Arslanian strolled through Grant Park on Monday morning, just hours after the final performers of Lollapalooza 2026 left the stage, capping a four-day run that packed the park with an estimated 400,000 fans, drenched the grounds in rain and left behind acres of torn-up grass.

The festival also left the city with its typical tally of modest mayhem: 10 arrests, zero tickets issued and 67 trips to the hospital, according to the city's Office of Emergency Management and Communications — figures roughly in line with recent years.

Lollapalooza's promoter, C3 Presents, is now on the hook for the cleanup, including what could be a costly restoration of Grant Park's grass, which had disappeared under the crowds by the festival's third day.

"It certainly is a presence," Radakovich, 36, who hails from the Pacific Northwest, said of the festival that has made Grant Park home for more than 20 years. She and Arslanian, 56, of Canada, joined dog walkers and runners in weaving around roadblocks and cleanup crews while an artist on a nearby bench sketched a scene of the park — festival aftermath and all.

Radakovich noted the event

See **LOLLA** on Page A4



Festivalgoers slog through mud at Lollapalooza in Grant Park on Saturday. **ARTHUR MAIORELLA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

ANALYSIS

Trump creates own issues by meddling

President hinders AG bid, imperils criminal case, tempts penalty

By Alan Feuer
THE NEW YORK TIMES

From the moment President Donald Trump was reelected, he has muscled his way into the driver's seat at the Justice Department, leaving tread marks on its time-honored independence from the White House by demanding, and sometimes directing, investigations into his enemies.

But his tight grip on the steering wheel has often threatened to lead the department off a cliff.

Last week offered a particularly vivid portrait of the consequences of Trump's meddling, which, in the span of only a few days, imperiled one criminal case, set the stage for sanctions in a second and gummed up the chances that his pick for attorney general will be confirmed by the Senate.

Trump has long believed that he is his own best adviser and

See **TRUMP** on Page A11



María's 6-year-old child stands at the corner of Randolph and Green streets while selling flowers in Chicago's Fulton Market neighborhood on July 24. **CHRIS SWEDA/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

How children selling flowers have become a staple of late night crowds

Experts say number of 'street-working children' is on the rise

By Allison Kiehl
CHICAGO TRIBUNE

On a recent summer Saturday evening, María and her 6-year-old daughter sat at a bustling intersection in the West Loop

with a large bucket filled with flowers wrapped in ribbon and decorative wrap. While María stayed on the street corner, the young girl wandered solo a short distance away.

As diners rushed to reservations at the trendy restaurants along West Randolph Street, the girl walked up and down the sidewalk. Without a word, but a facial expression that could tell

1,000 stories, she lifted up her flowers to those who her passed her by. Hoping one would stop.

It was a scene unfolding at nearly every nearby intersection at nearly the same time. The working children slipping between crowded street corners, extending a flower upward, making just \$5 or \$10 at a time

See **VENDORS** on Page A2

SUBSCRIPTION

Visit myaccount.chicagotribune.com or call 312-546-7900 to sign up for a subscription. To place an ad, visit placeanad.chicagotribune.com.

WEATHER FORECAST

TODAY H: 83 L: 69
WED. H: 81 L: 68
THU. H: 78 L: 64
Complete details on Page A20

INDEX

Almanac A11
Arts & Living B7
Comics B10-B11
Crossword B11
Editorials A6
Horoscope B10
Nation & World B4
Obituaries A11
Television B9

179th year No. 216
© Chicago Tribune

